

you can do it online. Within 30 days, the IRS will tell you if you've been accepted for the installment plan. The IRS will still charge you a monthly late payment charge of 0.5% of the balance due, up to 25%, plus interest and a one-time charge of \$52.

If You Need Help

If you have questions about how to complete your tax return or how the tax laws apply to you, go to www.irs.gov and click on "Contact IRS" to find your nearest Taxpayer Assistance Center, where you can meet with an IRS representative in person.

Once you've filed your return, if you have a dispute and need help with a problem, such as a missing refund or a penalty you believe was unfair, go to www.irs.gov/advocate to find your local Taxpayer Advocate Service office. You can also search for Publication 1546, *The Taxpayer Advocate Service of the IRS—How to Get Help with Unresolved Tax Problems*.

PAYING YOUR TAXES WITH PLASTIC?

Paying your taxes with your credit card may *seem* like a good idea, especially if your credit card has a rewards program that gives you say, airline mileage or cash back. But before you reach for your credit card to pay your tax bill, think it through: It's rarely a good deal.

First of all, the IRS charges you a "convenience fee" for using cards. This can range anywhere from 2.5% to 3% of your tax bill and this is likely to negate any rewards you are able to accrue. For example, say you owe \$2,000. If you get a reward of one mile for every dollar you spend, that's 2,000 miles, but those miles will cost you up to \$60 in convenience fees. Probably not worth it if it'll take you 25,000 miles to earn a free flight that would otherwise cost \$400. A better option is to use your debit card. The convenience fee in this case is usually \$2.95, and you might still earn miles. The IRS will walk you through the payment process on its website, www.irs.gov.
